

How to publish in Industrial Robot

Contents

- Our aim
- How to submit a manuscript
- What happens after initial submission
- Revisions
- What happens when you submit a revision
- Pre-accept
- References
- What happens when the manuscript is accepted
- Copyright assignment
- Proofs
- EarlyCite

Our aim

We publish only the highest quality research papers and follow a rigorous double-blind review process. Manuscripts are first assessed by the Editor and if considered suitable are then sent for external review by experts in the relevant field.

Even if the reviewers recommend publication it is most likely that some changes or additions will be suggested and the manuscript is returned to you for revision.

Following the first revision the manuscript will usually be sent for further round(s) of review and revision before being accepted or rejected.

Our aim with the above is to help you get the paper as good as it can be.

We also work hard to publish accepted work as soon as possible following original submission and our reviewers are expected to submit their reviews within two weeks.

Please note that **we have a policy of not publishing** work that has only been tested in theory or in simulation. This ensures that only the very best and most practical research articles are included.

Manuscripts are first submitted as a single PDF file (with all figures and their captions embedded) as this is easiest for both our authors and our reviewers. However we cannot publish from PDF files and so if a manuscript is accepted the authors will need to supply the manuscript as either a single Word document or in Latex files.

Although we do not have fixed limits on manuscript length we encourage authors to keep their contributions to 10 published pages or less. This equates to about 5000 words and 10 figures or tables. In our experience a short, carefully edited paper is almost always better than longer one, and shorter manuscripts can also often be published more quickly than overly long ones.

We are also keen to include videos and Video Abstracts to support published papers and these are then made available online. Videos give you the opportunity to use multimedia content to further describe and illustrate your work.

Videos should be included as YouTube links in the submitted manuscript. This avoids the many download problems that can be caused by large video files. The links can be included and referred to within the text and do not need to be made publicly available.

How to submit a manuscript

Manuscripts are submitted online via Scholar One Manuscript Central:

<http://mc.manuscriptcentral.com/indrobot>

If this is first time you have submitted to our journal you will need to set up an Author Account by clicking 'Create Account' at the top of the page.

Once an account has been set up go to your 'Author Centre' and then click 'Begin Submission'.

Manuscript Type – select 'Original manuscript'

Title – the title of a paper is its single most important attribute and has a great bearing on the number of people who will read the paper and the citations it will achieve. The title must reflect the content of the manuscript and should appeal to the widest number of relevant readers.

Category – choose from Research paper, General review, Case study.

Structured Abstract – This is second only to the title in influencing the success of a paper. It is also what we initially send to a prospective reviewer when we invite them to review the paper.

Abstracts should contain no more than 250 words and each section is limited to 100 words. Write concisely and clearly. The abstract should reflect only what appears in the original paper. If the abstract contains acronyms these must be defined within the abstract.

The structured abstract must be included **both** at the start of the main text and also entered separately into Scholar One.

<i>Design/methodology/approach</i> (*)	How are the objectives achieved? Include the main method(s) used for the research. What is the approach to the topic and what is the theoretical or subject scope of the paper?
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<i>Purpose of this paper (*)</i>	What are the reason(s) for writing the paper or the aims of the research?
<i>Findings (*)</i>	What was found in the course of the work? This will refer to analysis, discussion, or results.
<i>Research limitations/implications (if applicable)</i>	If research is reported on in the paper this section must be completed and should include suggestions for future research and any identified limitations in the research process.
<i>Practical implications (*)</i>	This section should include the practical implication and most importantly the potential commercial application of the work.
<i>Social implications (if applicable)</i>	What impact could this have on society as a whole?
<i>What is original/value of paper (*)</i>	What is new in the paper? State the value of the paper and to whom.

(*) compulsory

File Upload

Only **ONE** file should be uploaded at the time of original submission:

As the Main Document has to be anonymous for our double-blind reviewing process it must not contain any author details or Acknowledgements. The Main Document is a single **PDF** file that contains the main text, all the figures and their captions embedded within the document and the references. It should be single column and laid out as simply as possible. The idea at this stage is to make the document as easy as possible for our reviewers to read.

References should be in Harvard style format and listed in alphabetical order by author surname. Further details can be found at:

<https://www.emeraldgrouppublishing.com/how-to/authoring-editing-reviewing/use-harvard-reference-system>

Do **NOT** upload any files under Title Page, Figure, Image, Table, Supplementary File for Review or Third Party Copyright Permissions at this stage.

Videos

We are keen to encourage authors to submit videos to demonstrate their work. These should **NOT** be uploaded as video files. Instead please include links to YouTube videos within the manuscript.

Keywords

Supply up to six keywords for tagging the paper when archived in the database. Researchers will be more likely to retrieve the paper when conducting a keyword search of our database if your paper is suitably tagged.

Think of keywords as identifying the shelf on which a particular book might be classified in a library. Keywords should be neither too general e.g. 'automation' or too specific e.g. 'left-handed stainless steel hanger bolts'.

You can either choose from the list of keywords provided or enter your own. We suggest you select at least two keywords from our list of general topic keywords and then add in your own that are more specific to your research area.

Further guidance regarding optimising your manuscript can be found at:

<https://www.emeraldgrouppublishing.com/our-services/author-services/promote-your-work>

Co-Authors

It is essential that all co-authors' details are entered when a manuscript **is first submitted**. It is not sufficient to just name the co-authors in the Title Page of the manuscript.

Any post-submission authorship change or addition is only possible with a clear explanation and may delay the publication of your article

The author or any of the co-authors may be cited as the corresponding author. The corresponding author is our primary contact as the paper progresses through the review and revision process.

Reviewers

Authors may specify either reviewers that they would like us to invite (Preferred Reviewer) or reviewers that they specifically do not want us to invite (Non-preferred Reviewer). Our aim is to only invite reviewers that are expert in the relevant field and who can provide an unbiased objective opinion.

We may or may not invite the suggested Preferred Reviewers but we will not invite Non-preferred Reviewers.

Cover Letter

It is not necessary to include a Cover Letter but authors may do so if they wish and this is a good place to advise the Editor of any special considerations that should apply to the manuscript.

The Cover Letter is not sent to Reviewers.

Manuscript Information

The number of words entered should be the word count of the main document including any figure/table captions and references.

Open Access

If your manuscript is based on research supported entirely or partially by a funding agency with a conditional mandate it be made openly accessible, then there is an article processing charge of £2,495/\$3,370/€2,880 plus VAT added as applicable under UK VAT rules – simply supply the funding details below, and we will contact you. For more information see our website at:

<https://www.emeraldgrouppublishing.com/publish-with-us/publish-open-access/journal>

Review and Submit

This is a final review step before submitting your manuscript. All sections must display the green checkmark before you can click 'Submit' to complete the submission process.

Review each section carefully for accuracy and completeness. A green tick appears next to each item that has been completed correctly according to the journal's standards. A red cross indicates that you need to complete required fields. A yellow box at the end of this column details the exact error.

Click Edit in the right column to return to that step.

Click the PDF icon and review the submitted manuscript. If all is in order click 'Submit'.

If there are errors in the PDF then the file should be corrected and re-uploaded. If there are errors that you are not able to correct please contact the Editor:

Dr Clive Loughlin Emerald@coastlinetechnology.com

If the submission is successful you will be given your Manuscript ID. This uniquely identifies your manuscript and should be quoted in all correspondence with the Editor or Publisher.

Once you have submitted the manuscript you will not be able to edit it or make any changes until it is returned for revision. If you discover a significant error please inform the Editor immediately.

What happens after initial submission

The manuscript is first read by the Editor who decides whether or not the manuscript may be suitable for the journal.

If the quality of English grammar is not considered adequate for review, but the subject matter is of interest to the journal, then the authors may be invited to improve the manuscript before it is sent for external review.

If the manuscript is of interest then it will be sent for review by a minimum of two independent expert reviewers, we aim to provide a first decision within 4-6 weeks.

We operate a double-blind reviewing system such that the identity of the authors and reviewers are not disclosed. It is the author's responsibility to ensure that the text does not include anything that would disclose their identity or their affiliation.

Once sufficient reviews have been received the Editor will consider the comments and make a decision. This decision can be:

Accept	It would be most unusual to have a manuscript accepted at first submission.
Minor Revision	The paper is considered almost good enough, but could still be improved in some areas.
Major Revision	Significant changes and additions are suggested.
Reject and Resubmit	The present paper is not considered good enough for publication at this time, but the area is of interest and the Editor would be happy to consider a new paper from the authors in due course.
Reject	The paper is not considered suitable for publication in our journal. In all cases we aim to help authors maximise the quality of their papers. Even if a paper is ultimately rejected we hope that the authors will still benefit from the experience.
Pre-Accept	The Editor intends to accept the paper and authors are invited to submit the work as Word or Latex files and are also given additional advice intended to help them further enhance the paper and attract other researchers to read it. See section 'Pre-Accept' below.

Revisions

If the Editor invites the authors to revise the paper they are given a nominal 8 week period in which to make the revisions. We are always happy to grant authors an extension to this period if this will help them enhance the paper.

The revised paper should be submitted as a single PDF file.

It is most important that areas of major change are identified with **red text** so that the Editor and reviewers can identify them. It is not necessary to identify every grammatical correction or minor edit. Please do **NOT** use any 'Track Changes' features as these make further review very difficult.

Log on to the online submission site and, in the 'Author Centre', click on 'Manuscripts with Decisions' under 'My Manuscripts'. You will then see a list of all manuscripts you have submitted where the Editor has been able to make a decision.

Find the manuscript you wish to revise and click on the link 'create a revision' in the 'Actions' column. This will initiate a revised-submission process that prompts you to respond to the points made by the Editors and/or reviewers.

Continue to follow the seven-step submission process, providing information when prompted.

Step 1 – Authors response to reviewers' comments

This is compulsory. You should state clearly how you have addressed all reviewers' comments referring directly to the reviewers' comments. **Please do not add any information that could identify any of the authors** as this information is sent to the reviewers if re-review is required.

Step 2 – Type, Title and Abstract

Unless specifically requested to do so by the Editor or reviewers you will not need to make changes to this section.

Click 'Save and Continue' to move to Step 3

Step 3 – File Upload

Before you upload your revised files you must **DELETE** the original files.

Your response to reviewers' comments should also be uploaded as a separate PDF file ('Supplementary File FOR Review') and the order adjusted so it is **listed to be before** the revised paper.

Click 'Save and Continue' to move to Step 4

Step 4 – Keywords

Unless specifically requested to do so by the Editor or reviewers you will not need to make changes to this section.

Click 'Save and Continue' to move to Step 5

Step 5 – Authors and Institutions

Enter or confirm your name and institution information and add any co-authors and their information. Importantly, if any of the authors have changed their contact details please update their details.

Click 'Save and Continue' to move to Step 6

Step 6 – Details and Comments

Unless specifically requested to do so by the Editor or reviewers you will not need to make changes to this section. However the manuscript information (word count etc.) should be updated.

Click '[Save and Continue](#)' to move to Step 7.

Step 7 – Review and Submit

This is a final review step before submitting your manuscript. All sections must display the green checkmark before you can click 'Submit' to complete the submission process.

The final step is to view the PDF version of your submission by clicking on the PDF button. Please check the file carefully to make sure that it is complete and correct. The title page will not show in the PDF.

Click '[Submit](#)'. The system asks for confirmation of the submission. Click 'OK' to submit the manuscript. You will receive a successful submission confirmation along with your manuscript ID number. The ID will now have .R1 to indicate that it is a first revision (.R2 for second revision etc.)

The manuscript displays in the Submitted Manuscripts column of your dashboard.

Please note: Once you begin a revision, it moves into the "Revised Manuscripts in Draft" queue in the My Manuscripts section of your author dashboard. To continue, click the link and then click the "Continue Submission" icon in the manuscript display at the bottom of the page.

You must submit the revision within the specified deadline. If you do not think you will be able to do this you must ask the Editor for an extension. Once the deadline has passed you will not be able to submit a revision and may have to submit your paper as a new submission. If the Editor agrees to an extension, you will be able to proceed with the revision as outlined above.

What happens when you submit a revision

When a revision is received the Editor will check it and will often send it for re-review by the original reviewers and/or some new reviewers.

The reviewers will be sent the authors' response to their previous comments. It is by no means expected or necessary for the authors to agree with all of the various reviewers' comments, however they should show that they have considered all the comments carefully.

Pre-accept

If the Editor decides to accept your manuscript for publication it will be necessary for you to submit the manuscript in file formats that can be processed by Emerald's production system.

The PDF file submitted so far, now has to be resubmitted as either a Word document or as Latex files.

Please submit a PDF version of your manuscript **in addition** to the Word or Latex version as this is can be useful for verifying that equations and special characters are reproduced as intended.

Pre-accept is also your last opportunity to make any final corrections or very minor amendments. If you decide that significant changes are required (perhaps in the light of new research), then you should inform the Editor.

The document will also have to comply with the following requirements:

Format

The paper should be in single column format.

Sections should be numbered.

Avoid the use of any 'clever' automated features and keep the layout as simple as possible.

Any text that has previously been highlighted to show revisions can now be un-highlighted. However any significant new changes (e.g. change to the title) should be highlighted in **red**. Please do **NOT** use any 'Track Changes' functions.

Any 'Response to Reviewers' or similar comments that were previously include in the main document should be removed.

If you are submitting Latex files then you should also upload a PDF of the final version as the main document and upload the Latex files, as 'Supplementary Files'.

English grammar

Emerald expects authors to provide manuscripts written in good English. If the Editor has indicated that the grammar is not yet good enough for publication then we advise you to ask a native English speaker to help you.

You may benefit from Editage's services here: <https://authorservices.emeraldpublishing.com/>

Please note that there is no obligation to use Editage and using this service does not guarantee publication.

References

References should be in Harvard style format. Further details can be found at:

<https://www.emeraldgrouppublishing.com/how-to/authoring-editing-reviewing/use-harvard-reference-system>

References should be in alphabetical order by author last name and should NOT be numbered.

Figures

Figures can be embedded in the main document and should be accompanied by a caption.

They should be of very high quality and can be in colour or black&white.

Figure copyright

If any figures that are not your own or are attributed to other sources (or look likely to be the property of someone else), we will need to have formal permission from the copyright owners to reproduce them. If the figures are from a published paper then copyright permission will need to be received from the publisher of the paper and not just from the authors themselves.

It is **NOT** sufficient simply to acknowledge the source of a figure.

Please obtain all formal permissions that are required and copy and paste them into a single document called 'Figure Copyright Permissions' that is then uploaded with the Main Document to ScholarOne.

Please note that it is **ESSENTIAL** that we receive these Copyright Permissions and will be unable to proceed to publication without them.

What happens when the manuscript is accepted

Copyright assignment

When a manuscript is accepted for publication all authors are sent an email with a link to click for copyright assignment. This is a very straightforward process and it is essential that at least the **submitting author** completes the form so that Emerald has their formal permission to publish the work.

Full details regarding author's rights and obligations are given on the website.

Proofs

Authors are provided with proofs for checking prior to online publication – this is only for correction of typographic errors and should not be regarded as an opportunity to amend the paper.

EarlyCite

Prior to assignment to a particular issue the manuscript is published online in Emerald's EarlyCite system. EarlyCite publication typically occurs about six weeks following acceptance.

Authors are notified when their manuscripts are available to view on EarlyCite.

Papers published on EarlyCite are allocated a DOI number that can then be cited in other work.